CS5013 Final Project Report

IITM Explainable Slotbook

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Team Name: [TODO: team name]
Repository: `https://github.com/lazarsalt1441/CS5013-PROJECT`
Submission commit: `[TODO: SHA of the final-submission tag]` (date: `[TODO: YYYY-MM-DD]`).
Docker image: [TODO: Google Drive link]
Tagline: *It builds an IITM department's weekly lecture-slot timetable from course and preference data without breaking any hard rule, and explains why each course got its slot.*

AI-authorship clause. *We used AI tools to help draft parts of this report. The claims, numbers, commit references, stakeholder statements, and the Docker image are our own; the prose shaping may have been assisted. We can defend every sentence of this report, and every line of code in the submission commit, in the viva.*

1 Executive summary

Departments at IITM assign lecture slots by hand-editing last year's slotbook. Nobody can then say why a course got its slot, or what a clash would cost to fix.

We shipped a Java engine that validates five CSV inputs, solves with UniTime's cpsolver (an exact CP-SAT model is kept as a reference), and writes the slotbook with a reason for every assignment and every rejected slot. Students and professors enter preferences on a Vercel portal backed by Postgres, which also warns about missing prerequisites using the student's grade card. The timetabler downloads the CSVs from the admin page, runs one command, and publishes the result. The scope grew after the proposal to add the UniTime solver, the portal and prerequisite warnings. [TODO: check this sentence against your proposal]

[TODO: stakeholder verdict (accepted / partially accepted / not accepted) and the date of the final demo]

2 Course concepts used in the project

Java paths are under `src/main/java/in/ac/iitm/slotbook/`.

- [TODO: Module ?] – **Prompt engineering (CoSTAR, negative prompts).** All 18 AI tasks were logged before coding, as the request, a CoSTAR restatement and constraints grouped by who set them. `prompts/PROMPT_LOG.md`; `ebb9c28` (P015, logged before `7591cca`).
- [TODO: Module ?] – **Modular design behind interfaces.** Both solvers implement one solver interface and share one `Objective` class; explanations never look inside a solver. `solver/TimetableSolver.java`; `a57d2b9`.
- [TODO: Module ?] – **Reuse instead of rewriting.** We wrapped UniTime's cpsolver 1.4.94 and test that its score equals our objective. `solver/unitime/UniTimeModelBuilder.java`; `448f8b2`, `4cdf358`.
- [TODO: Module ?] – **Testing with independent oracles.** A separate constraint checker, penalty calculator and brute-force solver judge both solvers on seeded scenarios. `src/test/.../testing/ConstraintChecker.java`; `efdf10d`, `1a2feea`.
- [TODO: Module ?] – **Stress and fuzz testing.** Fuzzing, corrupted PDFs and 300 concurrent requests on Postgres found 3 faults, including a race that returned 500s. `portal/tests/stress/`; `2607a9d`.
- [TODO: Module ?] – **Structured debugging.** Each fault is recorded from reproduction to regression test, e.g. CI failing only on Node 20. `docs_v3/DEBUGGING.md`; `66ff082`.

- [TODO: Module ?] – **Version control and CI.** Branches and pull requests; GitHub Actions runs every suite, with a Postgres service and CLI runs on both solvers. `.github/workflows/ci.yml`; `8f2c000` (PR #1).
- [TODO: Module ?] – **Documentation as a deliverable.** A `slotbook(1)` man page kept current by CI, a manual, and a test plan listing every test. `man/slotbook.1`; `9ee919b`.

3 AI-usage summary

Tools used. Claude Code [TODO: %] (engine, portal, tests, docs); ChatGPT [TODO: %] (Vercel and Neon deployment). [TODO: other tools?]

One substantive help. Claude Code replaced the Google Sheets backend with a Postgres store, numbered migrations and database-backed tests (`portal/api/_store.js`, `7591cca`); it shipped near as-is once 4 integration tests passed on a real Postgres 16.

One substantive failure caught in review. The AI-written admin-dashboard check counted U and W grades as completed, contradicting our rule (spec drift, [TODO: Lecture 8/9 term]); a golden file shared with the Java CLI caught it before merge (`portal/api/_prerequisites.js`, `f528505`).

Net-effect sentence. [TODO: your honest verdict]. For reference, `docs_v3/DEBUGGING.md` records 9 faults in AI-assisted code that our tests caught, three of which had been in `main` since v2.

4 Deployment and stakeholder handoff

Build and run.

```
docker load -i slotbook.tar
docker run --rm slotbook --input data/feasible --output /tmp/out
docker run --rm slotbook --input data/prerequisite-warnings --output /tmp/out
```

[TODO: confirm once the Docker image exists]

Where the artefact lives after the course. Code on GitHub (above); portal at `https://cs5013-project-portal.vercel.app`. [TODO: who keeps it running after the course?]

Stakeholder quote (one sentence, verbatim).

> *"[TODO: stakeholder's exact words from the final demo email]"*
> *– [TODO: Name, role], [TODO: date].*

5 Known limitations

- **Optimality.** The default UniTime solver is a heuristic: on 3 of the 13 generated scenarios with a proven optimum it finished 1–8 points above CP-SAT (30 against 26 when instructors are shared). `--solver cpsat` is needed for a guarantee.
- **No identity on the portal.** Anyone can submit under any student ID, and grade cards are self-uploaded and unverified, so warnings are only as trustworthy as the uploader. It is not fit for real student data until IITM login exists.
- **Fixed rooms, one PDF layout.** Each course keeps its given room and capacity is not modelled. The grade-card parser reads only the IITM PDF's text layout, so scanned or photographed cards are rejected.

6 Individual contributions

- **Nishanth S:** v1 engine (CP-SAT model, explanations, CLI, JavaFX view, CI); the Vercel preference portal on Google Sheets; the mid-evaluation showcase dataset and submission pack. [TODO: confirm; add testing and stakeholder liaison]
- **Sparsh Gupta:** testing framework (independent oracles, generated scenarios, brute force); v2 UniTime wrapper and real IITM time grid; the prompt log; v3 Postgres backend, grade-card prerequisite warnings, stress tests, man page and docs. [TODO: confirm; add stakeholder liaison]